

>> broaden your horizons

Working out in your living room is convenient and is a good place to start, but if your body craves new ways to exercise, you'll probably want to broaden your horizons. The world out there is full of great opportunities for taking your exercise routine to the next stage.

Continue with the good work at home, but now try and make exercise part of your life on a regular basis. Here are some ideas for doing that.

Get out

If you've had fun doing the running workout, you may want to run or jog outdoors. The mistake most people make when they start running is going too fast, and that simply makes them give up. My favorite tip for beginners is "walk a lamppost, run a lamppost." That is, run from one lamppost to the next, then walk between the following two. When that feels comfortable, and you're ready to push

yourself a bit further, try running two lampposts and walking one. If you start to get out of breath, you can always walk two and run one, but be sure to pick up your pace again as soon as you can.

If you're out of shape, are carrying a lot of extra weight, or have any lower back, knee, or hip problems, it's best to start "low-impact"—marching or walking instead of running or jogging. And if you are older, try walking fast with weights or walking uphill rather than running. Both will give you a workout that's as intense as jogging or running.

Get in a pool

Swimming's a great form of exercise since it burns calories without putting any stress on your joints. The water takes the strain, supporting 90 percent of your body weight. Doing the front crawl is an especially good calorie burner.

But if swimming's not for you, then try aqua aerobics. Essentially, this is aerobic exercise (see p.99) in water. Again, the water supports a large part of your body weight, even though you're exercising in shallow water. A typical class will have you marching, walking, and running forward and back, jumping—even doing cross-country ski moves. It's just like doing my running workout (see pp.142–153), but in water.

Go to a gym

Going to a gym gives you the chance to work with different types of equipment. It also helps you to vary the type of exercise you do, which is good for

>> tips for your next stage

- **When you're outdoors**, run on grass rather than concrete. The strain on your knees will be far less. You'll definitely notice the difference.
- **When you go to the gym**, have an induction by one of the instructors. That way you'll use the equipment safely. You can also ask the instructor to create a program that's tailor-made for you.
- **When you join a class**, try to watch one first to be sure it's right for you. Most health clubs and fitness centers allow this.